

24-Week Sprint Triathlon Training Plan

Beginner-Friendly Extended Preparation

Race Distance: 750m Swim | 20km Bike | 5km Run

Target Audience: Complete beginners or those returning from injury

Prerequisites: Basic fitness level (able to walk 30 min, swim a few laps)

Weekly Training: 4-5 days per week | 4-6 hours total

Program Structure: 6 phases with extended base building

Program Overview

This 24-week beginner-friendly program provides ample time to build fitness safely. It features a longer base-building phase, gradual intensity progression, and more recovery weeks to prevent injury and burnout.

Key Principles:

- Gradual progression (10% volume increase per week max)
 - Extended technique focus
 - More recovery days built in
 - Lower injury risk
 - Confidence building through repetition
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PHASE 1: FOUNDATION BUILDING (Weeks 1-5)

Week 1: Introduction

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim Introduction (25 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: Swim 15 min (take breaks as needed, focus on form)
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (40 min)

- Entire session easy/conversational pace
- High cadence (90+ RPM)

Thursday: Run Introduction (40 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: Run/walk 25 min (walk breaks as needed)
- Cool-down: 5 min easy walk

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Easy Bike (45 min)

- Entire session easy/conversational pace

Sunday: Easy Run (30 min)

- Run/walk easy (conversational pace)

Weekly Volume: ~3.5 hours

Week 2-3: Foundation Building

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim (25 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 4 x 3 min easy with 1 min recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (40 min)

Thursday: Run (40 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: Run/walk 25 min easy
- Cool-down: 5 min easy walk

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Easy Bike (50 min)

- Entire session easy/conversational pace

Sunday: Easy Run (35 min)

- Run/walk easy

Weekly Volume: ~4 hours

Week 4: Build Week

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim (30 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 5 x 3 min easy with 1 min recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (45 min)

Thursday: Run (45 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: Run/walk 30 min easy
- Cool-down: 5 min easy walk

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Long Bike (60 min)

- Entire session easy/conversational pace

Sunday: Easy Run (35 min)

Weekly Volume: ~4.5 hours

Week 5: Recovery Week

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Easy Swim (20 min)

Wednesday: Rest day

Thursday: Easy Bike (40 min)

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Easy Run (25 min)

Sunday: Rest day

Weekly Volume: ~1.5 hours

PHASE 2: AEROBIC DEVELOPMENT (Weeks 6-10)

Week 6-7: Aerobic Building

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim (30 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 6 x 3 min easy with 1 min recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (45 min)

Thursday: Run (45 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog

- Main Set: Run/walk 30 min easy
- Cool-down: 5 min easy walk

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Long Bike (70 min)

- Entire session easy/conversational pace

Sunday: Easy Run (40 min)

Weekly Volume: ~4.5 hours

Week 8: Build Week

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim (35 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 8 x 3 min easy with 1 min recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (45 min)

Thursday: Run (50 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: Run/walk 35 min easy
- Cool-down: 5 min easy walk

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Long Bike (75 min)

- Entire session easy/conversational pace

Sunday: Easy Run (40 min)

Weekly Volume: ~5 hours

Week 9: Build Week with Introduction to Intensity

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim (35 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 4 x 4 min easy with 1 min recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (45 min)

Thursday: Run (50 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 4 x 4 min easy with 1 min recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Long Bike (80 min)

- Entire session easy/conversational pace

Sunday: Easy Run (40 min)

Weekly Volume: ~5 hours

Week 10: Recovery Week

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Easy Swim (20 min)

Wednesday: Rest day

Thursday: Easy Bike (40 min)

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Easy Run (25 min)

Sunday: Rest day

Weekly Volume: ~1.5 hours

PHASE 3: INTENSITY INTRODUCTION (Weeks 11-15)

Week 11-12: Gentle Intensity

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim Intervals (35 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 4 x 4 min at test pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (45 min)

Thursday: Run Intervals (50 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 4 x 4 min at test pace with 1.5 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Long Bike (85 min)

- Entire session easy/conversational pace

Sunday: Easy Run (45 min)

Weekly Volume: ~5 hours

Week 13: Build Week with Brick

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim Intervals (40 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 5 x 4 min at test pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (45 min)

Thursday: Run Intervals (55 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 5 x 4 min at test pace with 1.5 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Bike + Run Brick (75 min)

- Bike: 12 min warm-up, 4 x 10 min at test pace (2 min easy between), 10 min cool-down
- Transition: 2-3 min
- Run: 8 min easy into race pace

Sunday: Easy Run (40 min)

Weekly Volume: ~5.5 hours

Week 14: Build Week

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim Intervals (40 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 6 x 4 min at test pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (45 min)

Thursday: Run Intervals (55 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 6 x 4 min at test pace with 1.5 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Long Bike (90 min)

- Entire session easy/conversational pace

Sunday: Easy Run (45 min)

Weekly Volume: ~5.5 hours

Week 15: Recovery Week

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Easy Swim (20 min)

Wednesday: Rest day

Thursday: Easy Bike (40 min)

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Easy Run (25 min)

Sunday: Rest day

Weekly Volume: ~1.5 hours

PHASE 4: RACE SIMULATION (Weeks 16-20)

Week 16-17: Race Simulation

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim Intervals (40 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 6 x 4 min at test pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (45 min)

Thursday: Run Intervals (55 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 6 x 4 min at test pace with 1.5 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Full Triathlon Simulation (90 min)

- Swim: 15 min easy (simulating 750m)
- Transition: 3-5 min
- Bike: 30 min easy (simulating 20km)
- Transition: 2-3 min
- Run: 10 min easy (simulating 5km)
- *Practice transitions, nutrition, pacing*

Sunday: Easy Run (40 min)

Weekly Volume: ~5 hours

Week 18: Peak Week

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim Intervals (45 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 8 x 4 min at test pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (45 min)

Thursday: Run Intervals (60 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 8 x 4 min at test pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Bike + Run Brick (80 min)

- Bike: 12 min warm-up, 5 x 10 min at test pace (2 min easy between), 10 min cool-down
- Transition: 2-3 min
- Run: 10 min easy into race pace
- *Final hard effort before taper*

Sunday: Easy Run (40 min)

Weekly Volume: ~5.5 hours

Week 19-20: Recovery Weeks

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Easy Swim (20 min)

Wednesday: Rest day

Thursday: Easy Bike (40 min)

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Easy Run (25 min)

Sunday: Rest day

Weekly Volume: ~1.5 hours each week

PHASE 5: FINAL PREPARATION (Weeks 21-23)

Week 21: Return to Intensity

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim Intervals (40 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 6 x 4 min at test pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (45 min)

Thursday: Run Intervals (55 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 6 x 4 min at test pace with 1.5 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Easy Bike (50 min)

Sunday: Easy Run (35 min)

Weekly Volume: ~4 hours

Week 22: Begin Taper

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Swim (35 min)

- Warm-up: 5 min easy swim
- Main Set: 4 x 3 min at test pace with 1 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 5 min easy swim

Wednesday: Easy Bike (40 min)

Thursday: Run (50 min)

- Warm-up: 10 min easy walk/jog
- Main Set: 4 x 3 min at test pace with 2 min easy recovery
- Cool-down: 8 min easy walk/jog

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Easy Bike (40 min)

Sunday: Easy Run (30 min)

Weekly Volume: ~3.5 hours

Week 23: Final Taper

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Easy Swim (20 min)

Wednesday: Rest day

Thursday: Easy Bike (35 min)

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Easy Run (25 min)

Sunday: Rest day

Weekly Volume: ~1.5 hours

PHASE 6: RACE WEEK (Week 24)

Monday: Rest day

Tuesday: Easy Swim (15 min)

- Very easy, confidence-building

Wednesday: Rest day

Thursday: Easy Bike (25 min)

- Very easy, just moving

Friday: Rest day

Saturday: Rest day - Final preparations

- Lay out all gear
- Review race plan
- Early bed time

Sunday: RACE DAY!

- Arrive 1-2 hours early
- Warm up gently
- Trust your 24 weeks of training
- Have fun!

Weekly Volume: ~0.5 hours

Training Terminology

Test Pace (TP): The pace you can sustain for 4-5 minutes of effort.

Easy/Conversational Pace: You should be able to speak in full sentences.

Warm-up (WU): Gradually increase heart rate and blood flow.

Main Set (MS): The primary focus of the workout.

Cool-down (CD): Gradually decrease intensity to aid recovery.

Recovery Interval (RI): Easy effort between hard efforts.

Nutrition During Training

Pre-Workout (30-60 min before):

- Banana with almond butter
- Toast with jam
- Rice cakes with honey

During Workout (sessions >90 min):

- Water with electrolytes
- Energy gels or sports drink

Post-Workout (within 30 min):

- Protein + carbs (chicken with rice, protein smoothie, turkey sandwich)
 - Rehydrate with electrolytes
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Recovery & Injury Prevention

Sleep: Aim for 7-9 hours per night.

Stretching: 10-15 min after each workout.

Foam Rolling: 5-10 min on rest days.

Listen to Your Body: If something hurts, take an extra rest day.

Race Week Checklist

- ☐ Lay out all gear the night before
- ☐ Check weather forecast
- ☐ Review race course map
- ☐ Plan parking and arrival time
- ☐ Practice race-day breakfast

- ☐ Get good sleep 2-3 nights before
 - ☐ Reduce training volume by 70%
 - ☐ Maintain intensity but reduce duration
 - ☐ Eat familiar foods only
 - ☐ Hydrate consistently
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Remember: This is YOUR training plan. Adjust rest days as needed to fit your life. Consistency beats perfection. Trust the process!